

(a) Where order freedom enters

Every schedule uses 256 NFEs and commits exactly one token after each NFE.

after NFE t

after NFE $t+1$

after NFE $t+2$

□ eligible mask ■ committed now □ committed earlier □ ineligible mask

Sequential
 $B = 1$
w1 [M] [M] [M] [M] [M] [M] [M] → w1 [w2] [M] [M] [M] [M] [M] [M] → w1 [w2] [w3] [M] [M] [M] [M] [M]

eligible set = next position only; the ranking rule is inert

Block-parallel

$B > 1$

[M] [M] [w3] [M] [M] [M] [M] [M] → [M] [M] [w3] [M] [M] [M] [w7] [M] → [w1] [M] [w3] [M] [M] [M] [w7] [M]

every masked position in the active block is eligible; the rule picks one per NFE

Ranking

rule ($B > 1$)

Confidence-first (CF)

$$\max p_{\theta}(\tilde{x}_i | x_t)$$

Random (RND)

$$u_i \sim \mathcal{U}(0, 1)$$

Entropy-first (EF)

$$\max H[p_{\theta}(\cdot | x_t)_i]$$

(b) Conceptual crossing

